



Opera on Android gets crypto wallet

The Android version of Opera now has a built-in cryptocurrency wallet. It currently supports Ethereum; more to follow. <https://digit.in/jan19-25>



Texting tax?

Mobile phone users in California might soon have to start paying a tax for all the text messaging services they use. <https://digit.in/jan19-26>

initiators is Dr. L. Hardell, Professor of Oncology at Örebro University in Sweden. He states: “The telecom industry is trying to roll out technology that may have very real, unintended harmful consequences. Scientific studies, both recently and over many years, have identified harmful effects on health when testing wireless products under realistic conditions. We are very concerned that the increase in radiation exposure by 5G leads to damage that cannot be reversed”.

We still don't have long term studies about the effects of electromagnetic radio waves on human bodies or animals for that matter. All we know

is that EMF has a negative effect when the exposure occurs in close proximity. I wonder who might have a huge sum of money, big enough to influence studies that could go in their favour and allow them to expand and grow unabatedly? A hint: the answer starts with ‘tele’ and ends with ‘com’ and is a type of industry. Let's do a quick recap – 5G requires higher density of base stations and high levels of EMF exposure is bad for living things. Hmm... what could go wrong?

So is it time for us to grab the pitchforks and start picketing these technology companies that are about the spell the doom for humanity with

their 5G magicks? We could have, if they were actually bothered about deploying 5G in India. Some of the biggest telecom providers in the country have expressed no interest in deploying 5G in the country. Only Jio has promised to launch 5G services within six months of the spectrum being auctioned. So we're only going to see the first 5G ready telecom sometime in mid-2020 or later. So every 5G ready device that will be launched this year will be relegated to 4G for the foreseeable future despite the heavy price premium they'll command. Long story short, you shouldn't really bother with 5G till 2020. 

BUYING ADVICE

ADDITIONAL HDD IN LAPTOP

Q Hey Agent001, I was recently cleaning my HP laptop chassis and I noticed that there's a lot of empty space in one corner and there's even a connector on the for an extra HDD on the motherboard. It looks like a 10-pin connector but it's much smaller than the hard drive connector. Can I add another drive?

—Anupam



Install another HDD in your laptop

A Hey Anupam, Most laptop manufacturers use the same motherboard SKU for multiple models which is why they tend to have these extra connectors and most of them do work. Since you mentioned there's extra space within the chassis to house another hard drive, you can certainly buy one and give it a try. The empty space

might house a 7mm or 9mm tall drive, so measure the space before you buy the drive. Moreover, you might have to get the hard drive caddy that is compatible with the HP laptop, looking for spares on AliExpress or eBay.com will yield results. The caddy might be made of metal or rubber. Coming to the connector, the 10-pin connector you mentioned will require a SATA adapter for the hard drive. Here's one on AliExpress (<https://digit.in/SATAAli>) that'll do the trick. If you want the exact replacement part then go through the service manual for your laptop and it will be mentioned clearly. Ideally, you should also Google to see if others have had success with adding an extra HDD in the same laptop. Chances are, someone has done this and they would have listed the entire process online along with what worked and didn't work for them.

GOTTA HAVE AN ODD

Q Dear Agent001, I am a student and I want to buy a laptop for personal use. The budget is below ₹70000. I want laptop with Windows 10 64 bit installed. It should have a DVD-ROM drive installed. Processor can be an Intel Core i3 or higher. And a graphics card of NVIDIA that supports CUDA(GT200 or higher) and having a minimum resolution of 1024X768.

RAM of 4GB or higher. For GPU-assisted rendering a DirectX 10-compatible graphics adapter is needed. Disc space of 1TB or higher. Please help.

—Shreshth Jaiswal

A Hey Shreshth, Getting a laptop these days with an optical drive is tough. DVD-ROMs are slowly dying off thanks to the improved internet infrastructure and cheaper data



Optical drives on laptops are dying out

services. However, we can find business laptops continuing to support legacy media such as DVD-ROMs. Business laptops also tend to be a bit expensive because of the hardware that they use. We did find a few laptops with optical drives but the one that checks all the boxes for your needs was the Acer A517-51G-55RE. It's a bit expensive compared to the other units in the market with similar or better configuration but this one has the optical drive that you wanted. 